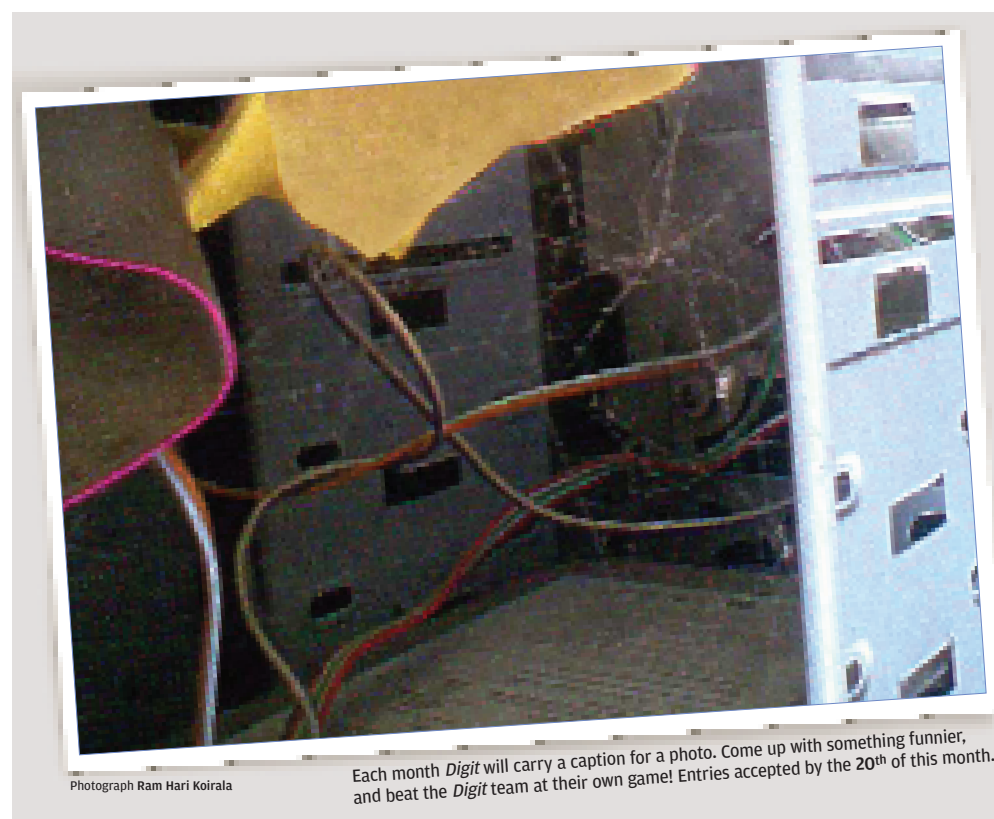




Photograph Ram Hari Koirala

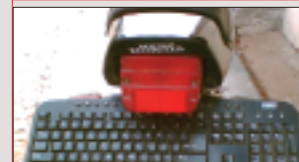
Each month *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 20th of this month.

Beat That!

Digit Caption

Look! Web access!

Last Month's Winner!
Abhishek Tiwari, New Delhi
"What was the shortcut to Connaught Place?"



E-mail your caption with the subject "Beat That", and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win

Fix Your Own PC
by Corey Sandler



Published by

WILEY-INDIA

to be the turn of Intel, the world's largest chip manufacturer. Some days ago, the European Commission raided the Munich offices of Intel. To add to Intel's woes, the Commission also raided the retailers that sold Intel's products.

These raids come in the wake of charges that Intel has slashed prices below costs, and also offered huge rebates in an effort to drive AMD out of the market. The Commission is already investigating charges on German retailer Media Markt, surrounding its sale of computers. Media Markt sells Intel-powered PCs, but none that run on AMD processors. In response to these raids, Intel's spokesman Chuck Mulloy said "there has been a raid on our offices in Munich. As is our normal practice, we are cooperating with authorities."

In the days of Core 2 Duo and Phenom, and the combined market dominance by Intel and AMD in the microprocessor

business, venturing into this area is as risky as a kid attempting to eat the juiciest burger in front of the class bully. Microprocessor start-ups are a rare, if even extant, commodity these days. The available opportunities in the form of server business are pounced upon with all might by the niche group of companies such as Sun and IBM. In the last decade, a company by the name of Transmeta Corporation—which once had Linus Torvalds on its payrolls—had attempted to eat into the microprocessor pie, but seems to have fallen miserably.

Montalvo Perry, a former CEO of Transmeta Corporation, went on to found Montalvo Systems, to venture into the prime zone of ultra low-power microprocessors. Montalvo Systems is once again in the news for claiming to have developed a multi-core, energy-efficient CPU for notebooks and "ultra portables". The Santa Clara-based start-up—which

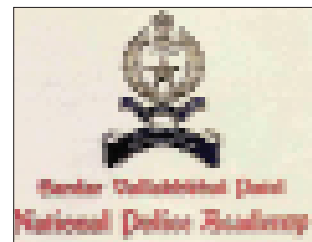
has a presence in Bangalore as well—focuses on processors with low power consumption. Although very secretive about their plans, there are speculations that Montalvo will make public announcements this year. Among its workforce, are former employees of Transmeta, NexGen, AMD and others. This name is surely going to be under the lens in the days to come, and most definitely by Intel!

ITALIAN JOB?

Thieves Ahoy!

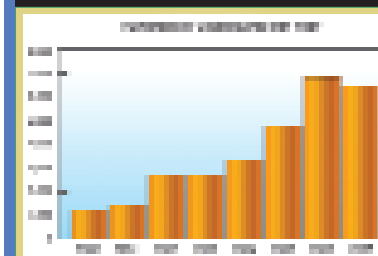
These days, most account transactions happen online. In these e-banking days, phishing refers to e-mails that appear to be sent from a legitimate source in an effort to obtain sensitive information from a user. For example, the email appears to be sent to you by

your bank, asking you for your password, or any other sensitive information. According to the IBM X-Force 2007 Trend Statistics Report, of the top 20 companies targeted by phishing in 2007, the report says, 19 are in the banking industry. With widespread risk of online transactions, we are all at risk to the latest pestilence. The X-Force collected and analysed 410,000 new malware instances in 2007, which is approximately 30 per cent more than those analysed in 2006. So, what is the average user supposed to do in the midst of significant forgery and phishing online? As it is said through the days—old is gold. What started off as a revolutionary



STAT ATTACK

X-force's graph on Vulnerabilities



2.1% of people have had a virus in their handset, **11.6%** know someone who has had a virus and **86.3%** of people have never heard of anyone with a mobile phone virus—McAfee Survey

Nearly 40% of all phone calls, fail to meet set industry standards, even in developed markets like the US and Western Europe

47% of men would give up sex for six months, for a 50-inch plasma TV, compared to just over a third of women

Roughly 68,000 servers on the Internet are returning malicious Domain Name System results according to Georgia Tech and Google survey

move, to do away with slow pace of processing, bank transactions that are paperless or online should be verified with a hard copy as well.

According to F-Secure Security Labs, the SVP National Police Academy in Hyderabad, had a Bank of America phishing site operating on one of their servers. After all, when it comes to money, there is no pride or tech-savvy talks—it's the money that matters. With the rise of social networking sites such as MySpace and Facebook, even this area of

the Web space is now a prime target for exploits. This justifies social networking sites giving cautious alerts to be aware of phishing activity.

OPEN THE WINDOWS

Windows 7 Gets Touchy

With Vista having borne tough comments from critics to the extent of being regarded as the biggest disappointment of

2007, Microsoft is all set to slate a 2009 launch of a successor. Named Windows 7, it will be more human-friendly with increased input options, as per Bill Gates, Chairman Microsoft. According to him, touch, speech and written text would be the significant development in the latest version of Windows. Gates claims that technical advancements in the areas of touch and speech would be incorporated into Windows 7. In a recent speech to Stanford University, Gates said, "It's a big step forward in terms of ink. It's a big step forward in terms of touch".

So what does that mean? In two years, Vista is no more? Was this all a tactic to get people to move out of XP and then force them to switch to another product? It started with gamers who were literally forced to upgrade to Vista because of the DirectX 10 compatibility issues springing up.

In fact, Microsoft is directly working with manufacturers, and in all probability computers would come fitted with touch screens and be able to accept inputs in the form of touch. Microsoft



has already hinted that Windows 7 would be "touchier", similar to Apple's iPhone. On the other hand, Microsoft plans to do away with DirectX 11. Apparently, with the hardware requirements of DirectX 10, and the customer resentment as a result of it, the software giant seems to have become proactive. We wonder whether our cell phones are becoming PCs or the other way round.

On the other hand, has Microsoft just added up features from their work on the Surface PC, the much hyped touch-enabled computer. With focus on touch, that is what it seems to be. Yet another bit of Microsoft hype... only the future will reveal the facts.

ALL IN THE HEAD

Gamers To Get Brain-controlled Headsets

With exponential progress, even the means for entertainment are going high-tech. The latest development for the gaming industry is from the US / Australian firm Emotiv. Scientists have developed a neuro-headset that interprets the interaction of neurons in the brain, which enables



XPERIA X1

Claimed as yet another iPhone killer by Tech evangelists and bloggers, the Sony Ericsson XPERIA X1 has on incredibly high-resolution (800 × 480), 3-inch VGA touch screen display. With a unique arc-slider design, the X1 features a new desktop GUI called 'Experia panels', a nine-panel interface that's eye candy on the high-resolution display. These panels are finger-friendly marvels that permit access to applications running on the phone via the home screen. Navigation is possible either by touch, arc-sliding QWERTY Keypad, 4-way joypad and an "optical joystick".

The X1 also has loads of other features like quad-band GSM as well as UMTS/HSDPA/HSUPA network support, WiFi, aGPS, microSD (400 MB on phone memory by default) and of course, Windows Mobile 6. X1 aims for the Web convergence market since it runs the Microsoft Windows Mobile OS for blending multimedia with Web communication. All the hype around the X1 leaves Sony Ericsson fans in anticipation, and it is expected to hit markets over the second half of 2008. There's no way can you expect it to be cheap. Nevertheless, keep drooling!